Tradelatest Quick Start (Grok)

One candle's journey — short-circuit the meta-layers

Generated 2026-08-07 from docs/book/
Grok review pass export — reading convenience only.
On conflict, repository code/config wins.

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Chapter 00 - Quick Start: One Candle's Journey

Part I - Foundations
Status of this chapter: Written (Grok review pass, 2026-08-07)

Why this chapter exists

The rest of this book is deliberately careful about *how* knowledge is classified, which record system owns what, and what remains unfixed. That meta-layer is load-bearing for contributors who will edit the repo - but it can overwhelm a reader who only needs to understand **what the trading system does**. This chapter short-circuits the meta-layers and gives the core mechanics in one pass.

What problem it solves

"I just need to understand the spine" without reading Chapters 3, 17, and 18 first.

What you need to already know

Nothing. Jump back to Chapter 1 when you want the *why*, or
Chapter 2 for the full invariant set.

The idea

The system in one sentence

Tradelatest takes **M15 OHLCV candles**, scores each bar through **four independent engines** (CRT, Gaussian, Zone Gate, RR), **fuses** those scores, **decides** accept/reject on semantic grounds, plans **entry geometry**, and finally allows or blocks the order through a **capital risk gate**. Everything is file-backed: no database, no message broker, no cloud dependency.

The happy path (one candle)

Step	What happens	Where it lives
1	Load candle (CSV / MT5 / live feed)	`src/inout/*_candle_fetcher.py`, loaders in runtime
2	Build a **39-dim** feature vector (no lookahead)	`src/features/feature_pipeline.py`
3	CRT state machine advances (RANGE->…->EXECUTION)	`src/config_layer/crt_engine_v2.py`
4	Four engines score the bar independently	`src/engines/*` via `EngineRunner`
5	Fusion combines scores under a completeness gate	`src/core/fusion_engine.py`
6	Decision Engine: semantic approval only	`src/core/decision_engine.py`
7	Execution Planner: intent + entry; CRT owns SL/TP levels	`execution_planner.py` + `compute_crt_levels`

8	Ultron Risk Gate: final capital / RR / exposure check	`src/core/ultron_risk_gate.py`
9	Live path: `HookedLiveEngine.process` on each tick	`src/runtime/live_engine_hook.py`

Backtests stream candle-by-candle through the same spine (`src/runtime/backtest_v2.py`). Live always runs the fusion gate; research/backtest gate mode is config-driven (`backtest.engine_gate_enabled`).

Priority order (not "profit first")

The system's declared priorities are, in order: **replay correctness -> explainability -> telemetry -> AI as advisory only -> profit**. Profit is a consequence of a trustworthy process, not a license to skip gates. See Chapter 1 for the full argument.

What is actually load-bearing today

Surface	Status (honest)
CRT state machine (mechanism)	**CLOSED** for OHLCV -> `TRADE_OPENED` boundary
Feature code surface (39-dim)	**CLOSED** for formula/PIT/write-site hygiene - not economic proof
Gaussian engine	**AUDITED** - live score collapses near-constant ~0.8825 (F-060)
Zone Gate	**AUDITED** - geometric HARD gate; non-pivotal on fusion decisions (F-036)
RR / rr_fusion	**AUDITED** - base RR flows; rr_fusion **disabled** (F-038/F-044)
BitNet / TradeNet	Built; **inert or unwired** on the active production config
Research Programs 1-8	**CLOSED nulls** under a fixed expectancy bar - discipline working
Active production config	`configs/production/ACTIVE_VERSION` -> currently `v2_multi_2026_04` on this branch

How config becomes production

1. Tunables live in `configs/production/*.json` - no magic numbers in hot-path Python.
2. `ConfigValidator.validate()` runs hard + soft quality gates -> `ValidationReport`.
3. Only `decision == "APPROVE"` may promote; SHA-256 hash + append-only `promotion_log.jsonl`.
4. Rollback = restore archived config + update `ACTIVE_VERSION`.

Details: Chapter 16.

How to read the rest of the book

If you want…	Read
Full *why* + invariants	Ch.01 -> Ch.02
Ontology, features, CRT depth	Ch.06 -> Ch.08

Engines, fusion, decision honesty	Ch.10 -> Ch.12
Geometry + risk + live path	Ch.13 -> Ch.15
Governance / findings / closure	Ch.16 -> Ch.18
Research programs + numeric results table	**Ch.19 -> Ch.20** (Part VII; also dedicated PDF `*Research-Grok.pdf`)
In-repo agent + multi-LLM ops	Ch.21 -> Ch.23
Open defects & book gaps	A2

Rule on conflict: this book is a map. Code and active config win.

Known defects you should not ignore (even on a quick read)

1. **ATR unit mismatch** in `compute_crt_levels` - SL buffer may treat relative ATR as price units (Ch.13 has proposed remediations; unfixed pending owner decision).
2. **CRTConfig split-brain (F-057)** - programmatic `BacktestRunner(cfg)` without `crt_config` can miss production JSON overrides.
3. **Doc-drift elsewhere in the repo** - e.g. some reference docs still say 38-dim; live code is 39-dim. This book tracks code.

Classification

Concept	Status
Candle -> order spine	Production
This Quick Start chapter	Orientation aid - not an authority surface

Authoritative sources

- `docs/architecture/signal-flow.md` - the 7-step walk with failure modes.
- `docs/architecture/goal.md` - purpose, invariants, priority order.
- `configs/production/ACTIVE_VERSION` - Tier-0 runtime truth.
- `src/core/engine_runner.py` - orchestrator every decision path passes through.

Unresolved questions

None for this chapter - open items live in A2.

Previous: Table of Contents * **Next:** Chapter 01 - Why Tradelatest Exists
Related: Chapter 02 - The Invariants and the Happy Flow
Memory: `docs/memory/architecture-memory.md` before editing the spine.